4.3

Break Out: Continuity and Change

In my initial address to the officers, as well as during the press conference on the eve of Army Day 2020, I touched upon certain key aspects that would guide me through my tenure as Chief. Consolidation was one of the facets. Our system being what it is, any new initiative takes time to ideate and mature into a formal proposal, which has then to be sent to the Ministry for consideration. Proposals may often require to be seen by various departments within the MoD or even require inter-ministerial consultations, before final approval and issue of a Government Sanction Letter (GSL). A proposal, initiated during the tenure of a former Chief, may materialize during the tenure of the next. Therefore, there is a requirement of maintaining continuity in policies from Chief to Chief. If that is to happen, then any new initiative must have all the Army Commanders on board, as it is through this collegiate that the next Chief(s) will be nominated. Concurrently, new initiatives, necessitated by technological changes or feedback from the environment, have to be initiated, which would in turn fructify sometime in the future. The Army is like a living organism,

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